The Life You *Choose*

THE MADE REAL BLUEPRINT / STEP 3

Go and move

Am I ready to rent a house with land near Góis for twelve months, from June 2027?

A twelve-month rental, not a purchase. My flat here rented out, not sold.

Anna · 1 March 2027

MY FIVE LIGHTS / AS I RECORDED THEM

Money	Papers	People	Place	Plan B
Amber	Green	Amber	Green	Green
Two remote clients signed, or €200 off the monthly costs	Residency file checked by my lawyer and ready to send	Lotte and I agree the dates I come back each year	The April visit confirmed the house and the village	The flat is rented out for the first year, not sold

The colours are my own answers on the day. Nothing here says that anything is ready.

THE CONDITIONS STILL OPEN

- **Money** — 28 February 2027
  Two remote clients signed, or €200 off the monthly costs
- **People** — 28 February 2027
  Lotte and I agree the dates I come back each year

My first step: Move the bookkeeping fully online, so the address stops mattering, before 2 March 2027.

02 / MONEY

What the numbers can carry

Monthly costs €2,360

Income I can count on €1,650

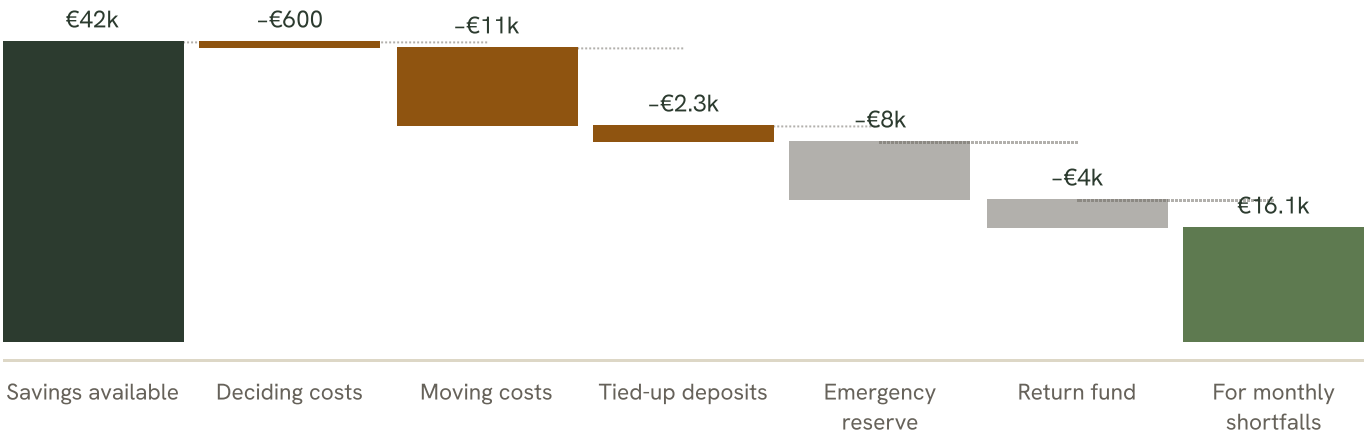
€710

short each month

On the income I can count on today.

Step 1 guessed €2,245 a month. Step 2 found €2,360, 5% more.

HOW €42,000 BECOMES €16,100 TO LIVE ON



22

months at €710 short

18

months I want

If everything costs 30% more: Costs €3,068, short €1,418 a month, and the runway falls to 11 months. That is under the 18 I want, so I would delay by a season and bank the summer work first.

My runway divides the money left to live on (€16,100), not my savings: the reserve and the return fund are kept out of it on purpose. Nothing here is advice; these are my own figures.

RISK AND A WAY BACK

What I will watch

The money works: a 22-month runway once the return fund is set aside, and that is before a single new client. The place held up on a second visit, alone. And staying costs me another four years of the same week.

01 The quiet turns into loneliness

Warning sign: Two months where I do not want to leave the house

Portuguese lessons from week one, and the market every Saturday whether I need anything or not.

02 A client leaves over the address

Warning sign: A quarter-end where Hendrik asks to meet in person twice

Fly over in March every year at my own cost, and say so before I go.

03 My mother's health turns while I am four hours away

Warning sign: A second hospital visit in one month

A flight budget kept separate, and the dates I come back fixed with Lotte in advance.

My own judgement of what could go wrong. The warning signs are things I will look for, not predictions.

MY WAY BACK

Keep a home. Protect a return fund.

€4,000 kept apart, which covers the van home and a first month somewhere. Lotte's spare room is where I would land.

I rent my flat out rather than sell it, so there is a roof to come back to.

THE ALTERNATIVE STILL ON THE TABLE

A four-day week in a cheaper Dutch town, with the garden allotment and Lotte twenty minutes away.

FROM DECISION TO ACTION

The order I will do this in

Nothing I cannot undo until the lights are green: the two client agreements in writing and the dates with Lotte agreed before I give notice, the flat rented out before I sign anything in Portugal, and the €8,000 reserve untouched.

1

MARCH 2027

Move the bookkeeping fully online

What must be true first: Nothing — this one I can do on my own

2

APRIL 2027

Rent out my flat, rather than sell it

What must be true first: An agent who will manage it while I am away

3

APRIL 2027

Give notice at the office, three months

What must be true first: Two clients confirmed in writing, which they were in February

4

MAY 2027

Sign the twelve-month rental near Góis

What must be true first: Notice given, and the flat let

5

JUNE 2027

Apply for residency

What must be true first: A signed rental contract as proof of address

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A COMMITMENT I KEEP FOR LATER

I rent for a full year before I even look at buying.

FROM DECISION TO ACTION

What I come back to

LOOK AGAIN / 1 APRIL 2028, AFTER THE FIRST WINTER

If neither new client had signed by the end of February and the costs had held at €2,360, I would have postponed by six months rather than start on a shrinking runway. The same rule stands for the move itself: a landlord who will not sign twelve months, and I wait.

Decided with: Lotte knows and agrees. Hendrik has confirmed the work continues wherever I sit.